stream. All 1.x versions of the CoffeeScript compiler use the Jison parser-generator (http://jison.org), so that's a good place to start. If you want a new language, you should probably start from a clean slate. At heart, CoffeeScript is just JavaScript.

8.4.4. It's just JavaScript

Amid all the excitement of modifying the CoffeeScript compiler to support whatever syntax takes your fancy on a given day, it's easy to lose sight of the wider ecosystem. You see, it's important that your CoffeeScript programs are still *just JavaScript*. Sure, JavaScript is increasingly becoming a compilation target for a wide range of different languages, but the power of CoffeeScript lies in only doing cleanups and being a small step from JavaScript for those people who want minimal syntax and can live with significant indentation.

Thus, Scruffy's syntax using the λ character is probably not something you'd do in practice. But support for the upcoming JavaScript `let` syntax (discussed in chapter 13) *is* something that you might want to add:

```
let x = 3
  console.log x
  # 3

console.log x
# ReferenceError: x is not defined
```

Listing 8.9 shows Scruffy's implementation of ScruffyCoffee that supports `let` by using a rewriter. This listing is invoked with an input file containing a `let` expression:

```
if true
  let x = 2, y = 2
  console.log 'let expression'
  console.log 'wraps block in closure'
```

The generated JavaScript uses a function closure to approximate a `let`:

```
var ok;
```